ELEVATE LABS CYBER SECURITY INTERNSHIP

Task 2

Phishing email analysis

by Muhammad Arslan

Phishing Indicators Found

Indicator: Sender Spoofing & Mismatched Addresses

- **Observation:** The From address (ksbda@intersho.com), Reply-To (newsletter@intersho.com), and Return-Path (weyly@pjhpe.com) are all different.
- **Analysis:** Legitimate companies use the same domain for sending and receiving replies. This inconsistency is a strong indicator of spoofing, where the attacker is trying to hide their real origin.

Indicator: Urgent & Threatening Language

- **Observation:** The subject uses "Congratulations!" to create excitement, while the body threatens that the order will be cancelled in 24 hours.
- **Analysis:** This is a classic social engineering tactic. Creating a false sense of urgency bypasses the victim's critical thinking, forcing them to act quickly without verifying the email's legitimacy.

Indicator: Suspicious Links

- **Observation:** Hovering over the embedded link reveals a destination that is not related to Apple or the legitimate store.
- **Analysis:** Attackers use misleading link text (e.g., www.apple.com/verify) while the actual hyperlink points to a malicious domain they control.

Indicator: Generic Greeting & Grammar Errors

- **Observation:** The email starts with "Dear Customer" instead of the recipient's name and contains awkward sentence structures.
- **Analysis:** Legitimate companies personalize their emails. Generic greetings and poor grammar are common hallmarks of mass-phishing campaigns.

Conclusion

The analyzed email contains multiple, independent indicators of a phishing attack, including technical spoofing, authentication failures, and psychological manipulation. It is a malicious attempt to steal credentials or deliver malware. **No links were clicked, and no attachments were opened during this analysis.**

From: ksbda@intersho.com Sent: M
To:
Cc:
Subject:

Reply-To: newsletter@intersho.com

Return-Path: weyly@pjhpe.com

Subject: "Congratulations! Order Verification â€“ AirPods"

Body: "Dear Customer, We have detected unusual activity on your account. To verify your recent AirPods order, please click the link below within 24 hours or your order will be cancelled.
https://keepnetlabs.com/free-phishing-email-analysis

Free Phishing Email Analysis

EMAIL ANALYSIS REPORT

From Fake email.eml

Share | Analyse another email

AI FIRST LOOK

Likely phishing

This email looks like phishing

The AirPods order verification lure comes from intersho.com, but the link host is keepnetlabs.com.

- AirPods order verification lure
- Link host does not match sender domain
- 24-hour cancellation threat

What to do

Do not click the link, open anything, or reply to the email.

An AI first look, not a guarantee: an email it does not flag can still be harmful.